Todor Koev

Curriculum Vitae

Ben Gurion University of the Negev
Foreign Literatures and Linguistics
Helen Diller Family Center (Building 74), Room 527
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https://todor-koev.github.io

Research Interests

Broad Formal and probabilistic semantics and pragmatics, Experimental linguistics, Dynamic semantics, Syntax-semantics interface

Narrow Parentheticality, Evidentiality, Modality, Gradability, Question bias, Indefiniteness, Adverbial modification

Employment

Fall 2024–now Senior Lecturer (tenure track)
Department of Foreign Literatures and Linguistics, Ben Gurion University (Israel)

Winter 2023–2024 Visiting Professor (substitution for Prof. Maribel Romero)
Department of Linguistics, University of Konstanz (Germany)

2018–2023 Emmy Noether Fellow
Department of Linguistics, University of Konstanz (Germany)

2014–2017 Lecturer
Department of Linguistics, Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf (Germany)

2013–2014 Postdoctoral Researcher
Institute of Linguistics, University of Stuttgart (Germany)

Visits

Summer 2024 Guest Researcher
Department of Linguistics, University of Konstanz (Germany)

Winter 2022–2023 Visiting Scholar
Department of Linguistics, Stanford University (USA)

Fall 2018 Visiting Scholar
Department of Linguistics and Philosophy, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (USA)

Education

2013 Ph.D. Linguistics, Rutgers University (USA)

1999 M.A. Philosophy, Sofia University (Bulgaria)
B.A. Business Administration, Sofia University (Bulgaria)

Publications

Book

2022 *Parenthetical Meaning*. Oxford University Press.

Journal articles

2026 "Biased Questions Project Answers to Resolve Issues" (with Cory Bill)
Languages 11(10), 212. doi: 10.3390/languages11100212. (SI: *(Not-)at-issueness*)

2025 "An Argument for a Strong Force Semantics for *Believe*"
Linguistic Inquiry. doi: 10.1162/ling_a_00544

2025 "Adverbs of Change and Dynamicity"
Natural Language and Linguistic Theory. doi: 10.1007/s11049-025-09661-9

2023 "Gradient At-issueness vs. Uncertainty about Binary At-issueness"
Theoretical Linguistics 49(3-4): 249–260. doi: 10.1515/tl-2023-2012

2021 "Parentheticality, Assertion Strength, and Polarity"
Linguistics and Philosophy 44: 113–140. doi: 10.1007/s10988-019-09285-4

2018 "Notions of At-issueness"
Language and Linguistics Compass 12(12): 1–16. doi: 10.1111/lnc3.12306

2017 "Quotational Indefinites"
Natural Language and Linguistic Theory 35(2): 367–396. doi: 10.1007/s11049-016-9344-x

2017 "Evidentiality, Learning Events, and Spatiotemporal Distance: The View from Bulgarian"
Journal of Semantics 34(1): 1–41. doi: 10.1093/jos/ffv014

2015 "Experimental Evidence for the Truth Conditional Contribution and Shifting Information Status of Appositives" (with Kristen Syrett)
Journal of Semantics 32(3): 525–577. doi: 10.1093/jos/ffu007

2015 "An 'Antiproviso Problem' for Appositive Relative Clauses"
Snippets 29(4): 11–12, doi: 10.7358/snip-2015-029-koev

Book chapters

To appear "Meaning Projection"
In L. Mayol et al. (eds.): *Handbook of Linguistic Interfaces*. Cambridge University Press.

2025 "Bias in Tag Questions" (with Cory Bill)
In T. Trinh et al. (eds.): *Biased Questions: Experimental Results and Theoretical Modelling*. Language Science Press, 145–178.

2019 "Adverbs of Change"
In D. Altshuler and J. Rett (eds.): *The Semantics of Plurals, Focus, Degrees, and Times. Essays in Honor of Roger Schwarzschild*. Springer, 283–303.
A shorter version appeared in *Semantics And Linguistic Theory* 27: 22–42, LSA.

Proceedings papers

To appear "Association with Contrastive Topic: Farsi *ke*" (with Maryam Mohammadi)
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 36

2025 "Speaker Attitudes Predict Epistemic Biases in Polar Questions: Evidence from Farsi" (with Maryam Mohammadi)
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 42: 266–273, Cascadilla

2023 "Vanilla Rules: The 'no ice cream' construction" (with Felix Frühauf, Hadil Karawani, Natasha Korotkova, Doris Penka, and Daniel Skibra)
Sinn und Bedeutung 27: 209–227, Open Journal Systems

2022 "*Really*: Ambiguity and Question Bias" (with Cory Bill)
Sinn und Bedeutung 26: 130–148, Open Journal Systems

2021 "Verum Accent is VERUM, but Not Always Focus" (with Cory Bill)
Linguistic Society of America 6(1): 188–202, LSA

2021 "*Believe* is Strong but Subjective: Experimental Evidence from Hedging" (with Cory Bill and Maryam Mohammadi)
Sinn und Bedeutung 25: 497–514, Open Journal Systems

2019 "Strong Beliefs, Weak Commitments"
Sinn und Bedeutung 23(2): 1–18, semanticsarchive

2017 "Parentheticality, Assertion Strength, and Discourse"
Sinn und Bedeutung 21: 679–694, semanticsarchive

2016 "On Quotational Indefinites"
Sinn und Bedeutung 20: 412–423, semanticsarchive

2016 "The Shiftability of German Appositive Relatives across Intensional Contexts: Two Experimental Studies"
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 33: 237–245, Cascadilla

2014 "Two Puzzles about Appositives: Projection and Perspective Shift"
Sinn und Bedeutung 18: 217–234, semanticsarchive

2012 "On the Information Status of Appositive Relative Clauses"
Amsterdam Colloquium 18: 401–410, Springer

2011 "Evidentiality and Temporal Distance Learning"
Semantics And Linguistic Theory 21: 115–134, eLanguage

2011 "Definiteness as Agreement: Evidence from Bulgarian"
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 28: 133–141, Cascadilla

Talks

Invited talks

2026 "Question Bias and Answer Salience" (joint work with Cory Bill)
At-issueness as Propositional Prominence, June 2, Ruhr University Bochum

2025 "*Believe* and Epistemic Subjectivity"
Linguistics Seminar, March 25, Chinese University of Hong Kong

2025 "On the Epistemic Weakness of *Believe*"
Linguistics Colloquium, January 21, Bar-Ilan University

2024 "Epistemic Weakness as Subjectivity: The case of *believe*"
Linguistics Department Seminar, December 17, Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2024 "Placeholder Indefinites"
Placeholders in East and West, October 10, University of Tübingen

2023 "Question Bias, Polarity Focus, and Salience" (joint work with Cory Bill)
InqBnB4: Inquisitiveness Below and Beyond the Sentence Boundary, June 20, Université de Lorraine, Nancy

2023 "Question Bias from Polarity Focus" (joint work with Cory Bill)
Construction of Meaning Workshop, March 15, Stanford University

2022 "At-issueness"
SFB 833, September 30, University of Tübingen

2022 "Parentheticality and Common Ground Management"
Syntax/Pragmatics Interface Seminar, July 5, University of Tübingen

2021 "*Believe* as Gradable, Strong, and Subjective"
Semantics Colloquium, July 1, Goethe University Frankfurt

2019 "*Believe* as Strong but Subjective"
Ernie Lepore's Semantics Workshop, April 25–28, Rutgers University

2018 "A New Semantics for *Believe*"
Department and Research Colloquium, December 13, University of Konstanz

2018 "Strong Beliefs, Weak Commitments"
LF Reading Group, October 1, MIT

2018 "Strong Beliefs, Weak Commitments"
At-Issueness, Scope, and Coherence, July 9–10, University of Cologne

2017 "At-issueness does not Predict Projection"
IPrA panel: *Foreground and Background: The Conversational Tailoring of Content and Context*, July 16–21, Belfast

2017 "Quotational Indefinites"
Syntax Seminar, February 23, University of Groningen

2016 "Parentheticality and Discourse"
Backgrounded Reports, January 15, University of Nijmegen

2014 "Appositive RCs, At-issueness, and Timing in Discourse"
Research Unit 1783: Relative Clauses, May 27, University of Frankfurt

2013 "Appositive Projection and its Exceptions"
Semantics Reading Group, December 3, University of Konstanz

2013 "Discourse and the At-issue/Not-at-issue Distinction: The View from Appositives"
Oberseminar, October 21, University of Tübingen

Refereed presentations without a publication

2027 "Biased Issues" (with Cory Bill)
The 49th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of Germany (DGfS): Language under the Microscope, March 3–5, University of Jena

2025 "Association with Contrastive Topic: The case of Farsi *ke*" (with Maryam Mohammadi)
The 12th edition of the TripleA Workshop for Semantic Fieldworkers, September 10–12, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies

2022 "Impersonal Rules: The case of general prohibitives" (with Felix Frühauf, Hadil Karawani, Natasha Korotkova, Doris Penka, and Daniel Skibra)
The 46th Conference of Generative Grammar in the South (GGS 46), May 19–21, University of Stuttgart

2021 "High Negation Questions are Always Polarity Focused and Sometimes Contain VERUM" (with Cory Bill)
The 43rd Annual Meeting of the German Linguistics Society (DGfS 43), February 23–26, University of Freiburg

2021 "Question Bias from Polarity Focus" (with Cory Bill)
Biased Questions Workshop: Experimental Results & Theoretical Modelling, February 4–5, ZAS (Berlin)

2019 "A Degree Semantics for Verbal Change"
Linguistic Society of America (LSA 93), poster, January 3–6, New York City

2015 "Quotational Indefinites: Bulgarian and Beyond"
Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics 24 (FASL 24), talk, May 8–10, New York University

2015 "On Appositive Projection and Its Exceptions"
Redrawing Pragmasemantic Borders, talk, March 19–20, University of Groningen

2015 "Verb Type and Mood in Shifted Appositive Relatives in German: An Experimental Study"
The 89th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA 89), general session, January 8–11, Portland, OR

2014 "Shifted Meanings Across Phenomena and Languages" (with Cornelia Ebert)
(Re)presenting the Speech of Others, talk, March 13–14, University of Groningen

2014 "Shifted Appositives and Shifted Indexical Pronouns: Who Said It?"
The 88th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA 88), general session, January 3–5, Minneapolis, MN

2012 "An Experimental Investigation of the Semantic Contribution of Appositives" (with Nicholas Angelides & Maxwell Kramer)
Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning 2 (MACSIM 2), poster, February 18, University of Maryland

2011 "Temporal and Grounding Properties of Appositive Relative Clauses"
The 42nd Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society (NELS 42), general session, November 11-13, University of Toronto

2011 "Appositives in Discourse"
Third Workshop on Projection, Entailment, Presupposition and Assertion (PEPA 3), poster, May 19, Rutgers University

2010 "Evidentiality as a Link between Speakers, Times, and Events"
Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning 1 (MACSIM 1), poster, April 10, University of Pennsylvania

Grants

2025–2027 Personal Research Grant at Israel Science Foundation (Ref 3464/25, ILS 220,000)
Project: *Ingredients of Question Bias: The Role of Answer Salience*

2018–2023 Emmy Noether Program at Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (KO 5704/1-1, €746,850)
Project: *Parenthetical Meaning*

2016 *Strategic Research Grant* (€10,639), University of Düsseldorf
Project: *Parenthicality and Discourse*

2012–2013 *Mellon Dissertation Fellowship* ($27,000), Rutgers University

2011 *Mellon Summer Research Grant* ($4,000), Rutgers University

Teaching

Ben Gurion University

Fall 2026–27 *Focus*. B.A. level seminar. Instructor
Subjectivity. B.A. level elective. Instructor

Spring 2026 *Mood selection*. B.A. level seminar. Instructor
Question Bias. B.A. level elective. Instructor

Fall 2025–26 *Bias in Public Discourse*. B.A. level elective. Instructor
Semantics. B.A. level advanced course. Instructor

Spring 2025 *Introduction to Semantics*. B.A. level foundational course. Instructor

2024–2025 *Modality in Semantics*. B.A. level elective. Instructor

University of Konstanz

Winter 23–24 *Modality and Gradability*. M.A./Ph.D. level seminar. Instructor
Formal Methods in Linguistics. M.A. level class. Instructor
Pragmatics I. B.A. level introduction. Instructor

W 23–24, S 22 *Sociolinguistics: Bias in Public Discourse*. B.A. level seminar. Instructor

Winter 21–22 *Question Bias*. M.A./Ph.D. level seminar. Instructor

Summer 2020 *Core Components of Language B*. M.A. level introduction to syntax, semantics, and pragmatics. Instructor

University of Düsseldorf

S 17, 16, 15 *Introduction to Pragmatics*. B.A. level introduction. Instructor

W 2016–2017 *Dynamic Semantics*. B.A. level seminar. Instructor

	Hidden Meaning in Public Discourse. B.A. level seminar. Instructor
W 2015–2016	*Modals, Attitudes, and Conditionals*. B.A. and M.A. level seminar. Instructor
Summer 2015	*Scope, Perspective, Projection*. B.A. level seminar. Instructor
W 2014–2015	*Entailment, Implicature, Presupposition*. B.A. level seminar. Instructor
W 2014–2015	*Introduction to Logic*. B.A. level introduction. Instructor
	Rutgers University
S 2012, F 2011	*Semantics*. Lecturer
Spring 2010	*Introduction to Linguistic Theory*. Lecturer
F 2009, F 2008	*Introduction to the Study of Language*. Teaching Assistant for Prof. Paul de Lacy
Spring 2008	*Semantics*. Grader for Prof. Roger Schwarzschild
	University of Delaware
Spring 2007	*Introduction to Linguistics*. Tutor for Prof. Gabriela Hermon
Fall 2006	*Philosophy of Mind*. Grader for Prof. Fred Adams

Supervision

Graduate

2025 Saeedeh Salimifar, *Projective meaning: An Experimental and Computational Study*. Ph.D. thesis, University of Oslo, Second opponent

2024 Maryam Mohammadi, *Bias Conditions in Polar Questions and Answers: A study of bias effects in Farsi*. Ph.D. thesis, University of Konstanz, Chair

Undergraduate

2024 Simon Janik, *The Pragmatics of Emojis in Questions*. B.A. thesis, University of Konstanz, Co-chair

2021 Annika Kniele, *Discourse Particles: The Double Life of German 'schon' and French 'déjà'*. B.A. thesis, University of Konstanz, Co-chair

2021 Dominik Messmer, *The Meaning of German Response Particles as Responses to Negative Polar Questions*. B.A. thesis, University of Konstanz, Co-chair

Reviewing

Foundations	*National Science Foundation, Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft, Austrian Science Fund*
Volumes	*Oxford University Press, Cambridge University Press, Springer*
Journals	*Semantics and Pragmatics* (editorial board), *Linguistics and Philosophy, Natural Language Semantics, Journal of Semantics, Glossa, Glossa Psycholinguistics, Language, Linguistic Inquiry, Journal of Pragmatics, Acta Linguistica Academica, Languages, Cognitive Science, Synthese, Philosophical Studies, Philosophical Quarterly, Snippets*
Conferences	*Semantics and Linguistics Theory, Sinn und Bedeutung, North East Linguistics Society, West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, Generative Linguistics in the Old World, Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics, Linguistic Society of America, Israel Association for Theoretical Linguistics*

Organizing

2025–2027 *Linguistics Colloquium* (Ben Gurion University)
Main organizer

2019 *Expressing Evidence* (University of Konstanz)
Co-organized with Regine Eckardt, Sven Lauer, Natasha Korotkova

2011 *Semantics And Linguistics Theory* 21 (Rutgers University)
On-site management and budget

2008–2012 *Semantics Research Group* (Rutgers University)
Main organizer